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Measures of Adoption in the EVM

We introduce the h-index and recipient dominance ratio metrics for analyzing onchain activity growth, comparing trends across EVM ecosystems.

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Measuring onchain adoption is a challenging endeavor, with standard methodologies such as transaction counts and active addresses historically subject to distortions from sybil and inscription linked activity. More sustainable adoption metrics like total value locked (TVL) or other liquidity-based measures, however, are lagging indicators in our view. They also do not apply to non-financial onchain applications (e.g. decentralized social) that have recently become more prominent.

We believe new sets of metrics are needed to appropriately capture these changing activity trends. We expand upon our previously proposed [h-index](#) metric, which balances activity growth with diversity. In our view, the h-index serves as a strong early indicator for widespread adoption in the absence of relevant TVL-based metrics. Sustained h-index levels may also suggest a more resilient community during market downturns. Indeed, our models suggest many of the currently prominent chains have had comparatively strong h-index measurements throughout the bear cycle. The h-index metric suggests that the broadest onchain adoption is currently occurring on Ethereum and Base.

To further highlight onchain protocol diversity, we introduce the recipient dominance ratio (RDR), which is the proportion of transaction counts or fees that the top 10 recipient addresses account for. This measurement provides color on the concentration of onchain activity drivers. Ethereum has the most diverse range of demand measured by

transaction counts, while Polygon PoS has the most diverse by fees spent. The difference between transaction counts and transaction fee ratios also signals the nature of activity that occurs on each chain, with financial linked activity typically seeing a higher concentration of transaction fees versus counts.

For more details, see our [full report](#).

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